define the same method, the last defined one will win, leading to potentially hard-to-find bugs.

Later in Chapter 22, Metaprogramming, on page 373), we'll talk about *refinements*, a Ruby feature that gives you the benefit of re-opening classes, but also limits the scope of your changes.

What's Next

There's more to say about classes and objects in Ruby. We still have to look at class methods and at concepts such as mixins and inheritance. We'll do that in Chapter 6, Sharing Functionality: Inheritance, Modules, and Mixins, on page 101. But, for now, know that everything you manipulate in Ruby is an object and that objects start life as instances of classes. And one of the most common things we do with objects is create collections of them. But that's the subject of our next chapter.